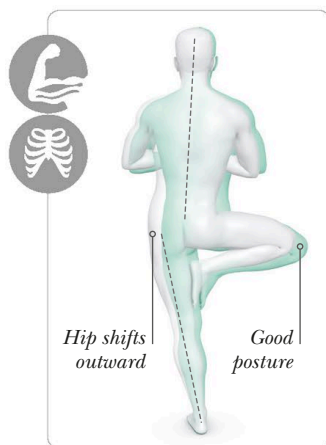


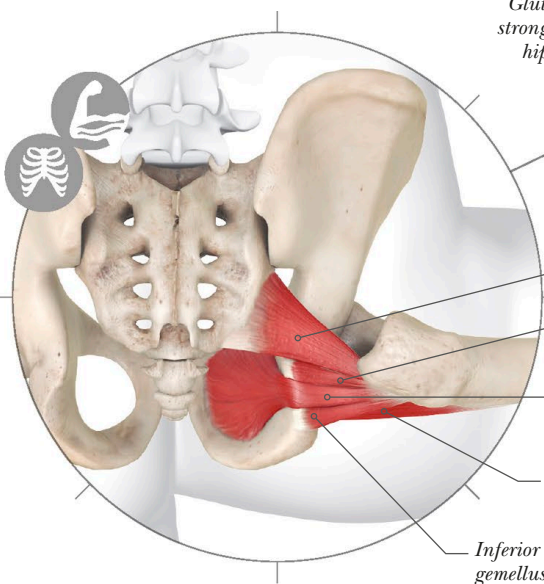
» CLOSER LOOK

Tree pose stabilizes your hips in a unique position. Holding the pose increases body awareness, particularly in the sole of your standing foot. Breathe steadily and focus.



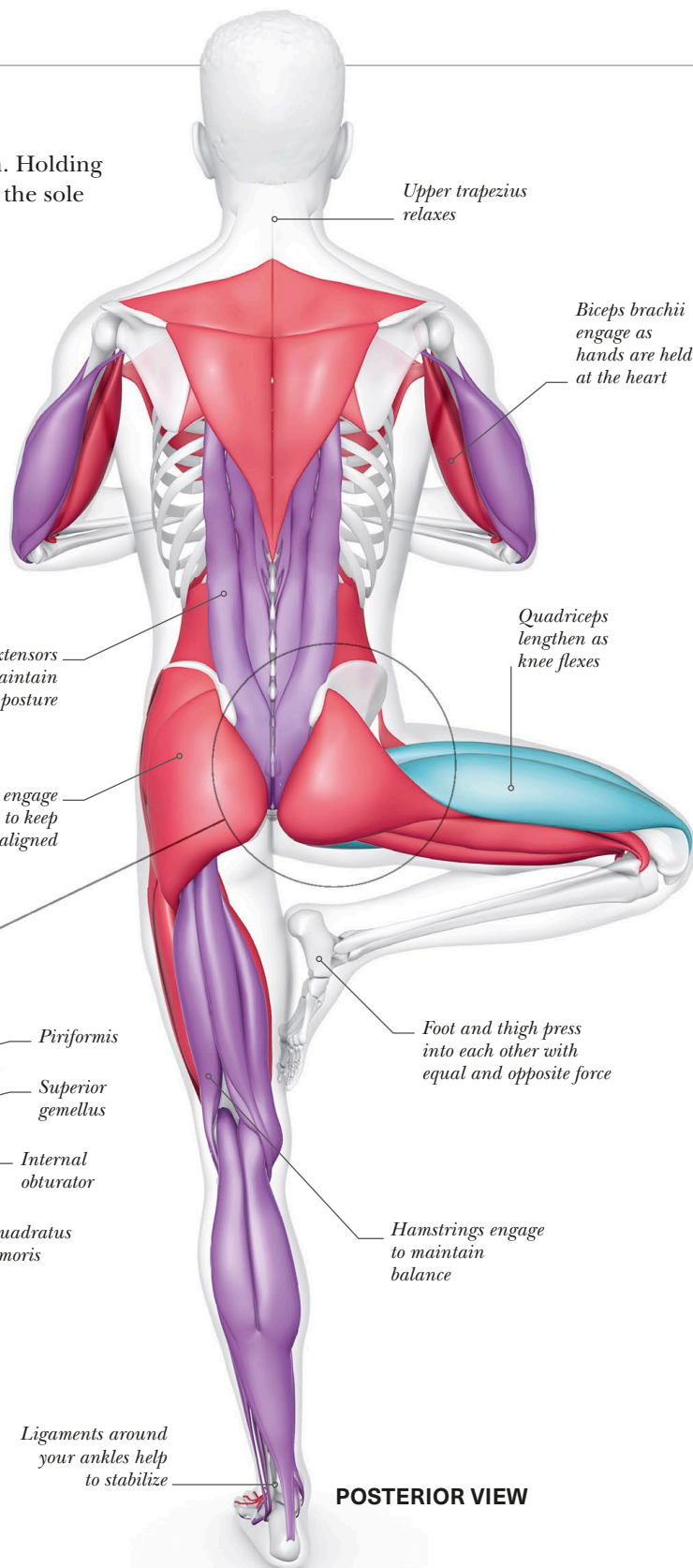
Hip abductors

If you are not engaging your hip abductors, particularly your gluteus medius, on your standing thigh, your hip will hike out. This is tough for balance and a common bad postural habit you may mindlessly do. To counteract this, press your standing hip in, bringing your pelvis to neutral.



Deep six

To rotate your hip out to the side you engage a set of six small muscles deep within your hip joint. Strong standing poses, such as Tree, dynamically stretch and strengthen the deep six external rotators. To get a deeper stretch in these muscles, try stretches like King Pigeon (see pp.80–83).



POSTERIOR VIEW